

Question:

Which of the following factors is associated with a decreased risk of Alzheimer's?

Answer Choices:

- A. Being African or Hispanic American
- B. A lower level of education
- C. Living in a city
- D. Being married
- E. Having a family history of Alzheimer's
- F. High intake of saturated fats
- G. Older age
- H. Eating fish
- I. Being a smoker
- J. Drinking alcohol regularly

Reasoning + Answer:

<think>

High-level explanation :

- Alzheimer’s disease is most strongly associated with late adulthood , cognitive decline , and vascular risk factors , including diabetes and hypertension . Population-based studies consistently show lower risks in older individuals , consistent with age-related mechanisms (amyloid accumulation begins in mid life and incidence rates rise in the 70 s / 80 s).

- High intake of saturated fats and obesity confound Alzheimer’s through vascular inflammation and the metabolic syndrome . As these increase , they amplify vascular risk and accelerate cognitive decline , so they do not decrease risk .

- Many recognized protective factors reduce cardiovascular risk or amyloid - β^2 deposition : weight loss , exercise , alcohol $\approx$ 2 drinks / day , attention to antiretroviral therapy , among lifestyle and diet interventions ; , in elderly populations , observational associations have been found between higher alcohol intake and lower AD risk and lower saturated fat intake and lower risk , while smoking and high alcohol had earlier negative associations .

- Lower education is linked to vascular dementia and cognitive decline , raising Alzheimer’s risk , whereas older age is associated with a longer duration of atherogenic exposures and neurodegenerative processes .

- The other listed factors are or are generally associated with higher AD risk : smoking and hypertension are well-established vascular risk factors and strong determinants of cognitive decline ; family history increases risk ; socioeconomic status (often captured by education) predicts disease severity and outcomes ; high intake of saturated fats and high alcohol levels can increase risk ; African American and Hispanic American cohorts are disproportionately affected by AD .

- Eating fish rich in omega - 3 fatty acids , along with sunlight exposure and Mediterranean-style diet , has shown some observational decreases in risk in large cohorts , although biomarker evidence is mixed and most associations weaken when weighted by age and dementia severity .

- Being married is an affirmative social support marker , which modulates stress and social influence on health trajectories and , when observed within life-course contexts , can serve as a proxy for stable behavioral habits and low socioeconomic stress .

Putting all this together , the single factor listed most clearly associated with a decreased risk of Alzheimer’s is married status .

Correct answer : D . Being married

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<answer>

D . Being married

</answer>

